

# How You Got Happiness?: Part I - Knowledge And The Transformation Of Man

J. Krishnamurti

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## Chapter 1

# Knowledge and the Transformation of Man

This chapter follows the first San Diego conversation between J. Krishnamurti and Allan W. Anderson on knowledge and the transformation of man. There are no validated blackboard equations or usable screenshot figures for this lecture, so the formal material is necessarily modest. We use equations, tables, and diagrams as disciplined notation for the spoken inquiry: not to force mathematics onto the dialogue, but to keep visible the order of its argument. The lecture moves from world disorder, to the responsibility of the human being, to the non-separation of the human being and the world, to division, knowledge, image, and finally to the unresolved question of actual freedom from the known.

### 1.1 The Disorder That Raises the Question

The lecture does not begin with a method. It begins with a pressure. Krishnamurti asks us to look at what is happening in the world: cultural degeneration, religious authority without religious spirit, political confusion, misery, sorrow, and the ordinary human habit of answering deep disorder with superficial concern.

This opening matters. If it is compressed into a general complaint that the world is troubled, the lecture loses its motive. The question of knowledge is not introduced as an academic topic. It appears because the familiar agencies of change have failed to touch the root of human disorder. One may change institutions, policies, slogans, and outward arrangements, but the mind that has made disorder may continue unchanged.

The first movement can be written schematically:

$$\text{world disorder} \longrightarrow \text{question of human transformation.} \quad (1.1)$$

This is not a causal theorem. It is the order of attention. First there is the seeing of disorder; then there is the serious question whether the human being can undergo radical transformation.

Krishnamurti refuses to place that responsibility on the mass, the priest, the church, the temple, the mosque, the politician, the scientist, or the businessman. The responsibility belongs to the human being who sees the confusion. The lecture therefore narrows, but it does not become private. It

moves from the world to the human being because the human mind is not outside the world it has made.

## 1.2 Individual, Human Being, Whole

Anderson first names the point as the responsibility of the individual. Krishnamurti immediately slows the word down. In ordinary usage, an individual is a countable unit: one person among others. But the word also means undivided, indivisible. In that sense, a fragmented human being is not yet an individual.

We can keep the distinction explicit:

$$\text{individual}_{\text{ordinary}} = \text{one separate person}, \quad (1.2)$$

$$\text{individual}_{\text{qualitative}} = \text{undivided, whole, unfragmented}. \quad (1.3)$$

The second line is the important one. A person may have a name, a house, a bank account, and a social identity, and still be inwardly broken into contradiction. Such a person is separate in the ordinary sense but not individual in Krishnamurti's qualitative sense.

The word "whole" then gathers several meanings. Krishnamurti connects it with sanity, health, and holiness. This is not a sectarian claim. It is a way of saying that wholeness is not merely an improved psychological condition; it is the ending of inward fragmentation.

**Definition 1.1.** A whole human being, in this chapter, means a human being who is not inwardly divided by contradiction, conflict, and competing desire. The term follows Krishnamurti's qualitative usage: whole, sane, healthy, and therefore holy.

Responsibility now has a more exact meaning. It is not guilt, nor a vague duty to be better. Krishnamurti gives it texture: responsibility implies attention, care, and diligence. It is the opposite of negligence. If the human being is related to the whole of mankind, then responsibility cannot be delegated away.

### 1.2.1 Question & Answer

**Question.** If transformation begins with each human being, does that make the inquiry private and individualistic?

**Answer.** No. This is the first local obstacle in the conversation, and the lecture pauses over it. Anderson asks about the relation between "each" and "we." Krishnamurti answers by pointing to the common structure of human life. Wherever human beings live, they face sorrow, fear, livelihood, relationship, survival, life, and death. These are not essentially eastern problems or western problems. They are human problems.

So the beginning is with each human being, but the field is not private. The human being who begins is already in relation to mankind as a whole. This prevents two evasions at once: one cannot hide inside the collective, and one cannot retreat into isolated self-improvement.

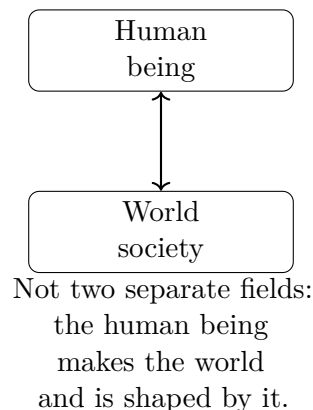


Figure 1.1: A conceptual reconstruction of the lecture's non-separation claim.

### 1.3 The Human Being Is the World

The next step is the central structural claim of the lecture:

$$\text{human being} \leftrightarrow \text{world}. \quad (1.4)$$

The arrow does not mean simple mutual influence. Krishnamurti's claim is stronger: the human being is the world, and the world is the human being. Human beings have made society through greed, anger, violence, pettiness, ambition, fear, and the search for security. At the same time, each human being is shaped by culture, tradition, language, and the social order into which he or she is born.

This is why changing the outward structure alone cannot answer the question. Krishnamurti refers to the idea that changing environment or social structure will change man. He treats that as inadequate. It may polish the surface. It may rearrange conditions. But if the mind that creates disorder remains the same, the root has not changed.

The lecture rejects the simple sequence

$$\text{change environment} \longrightarrow \text{change human being}. \quad (1.5)$$

It also rejects the private opposite, as if a separate person first perfects himself and later affects society. The inward and outward are not two independent orders. In the lecture's terms,

$$\text{root change in the human being} \longleftrightarrow \text{change in the world}. \quad (1.6)$$

That is why Anderson's phrase about a non-temporal relation is useful. The point is not first inward change, then outward change, as two events in a timetable. The human being and the world are already implicated in one movement.

### 1.4 Change at the Root, Not Gradual Improvement

The conversation then examines the word revolution. In ordinary political language, revolution may mean overthrowing a government. Krishnamurti distinguishes that from psychological revolution, a revolution in the structure and nature of thought.

|                          |                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Outward revolution       | Change of government, institution, policy, or social structure. It may be dramatic, but it need not touch the root of the mind.           |
| Gradual evolution        | Slow psychological improvement through time. In this dialogue, gradualness becomes postponement when the issue is radical transformation. |
| Psychological revolution | Change in the way the human being thinks, behaves, conducts himself, and functions; a change in the very make-up of the mind.             |

Table 1.1: Three senses of change separated in the conversation.

The word “instant” appears, but Krishnamurti is wary of it. He does not want to suggest a sudden magical event. Yet he also rejects gradual psychological evolution as an endless process. The issue is not speed by the clock. The issue is whether transformation depends on time as postponement.

A compact notation helps preserve the distinction:

$$\text{surface reform} \neq \text{root transformation}, \quad (1.7)$$

$$\text{gradual psychological progress} \neq \text{freedom from the old}. \quad (1.8)$$

This is a recurring rhythm in the lecture. Anderson formulates a question; Krishnamurti accepts what is useful, then brings the inquiry back to the root. The problem is not merely social arrangement, nor the word “change,” nor a theory of transformation. The problem is the human mind as it actually functions.

## 1.5 Division, Conflict, and False Security

Once the inner and the outer are no longer treated as separate, division becomes the next necessary topic. The world is divided into East and West, religions, nationalities, ideologies, classes, and opposing groups. The human being is also divided inwardly and socially: Christian and non-Christian, Hindu and Muslim, capitalist and socialist, we and they, I and you.

Krishnamurti gives the relation almost as a basic law:

$$\text{Division} \longrightarrow \text{Conflict}. \quad (1.9)$$

We should not turn this into a formal theorem. It is a disciplined observation in the dialogue. Where there is division, there is opposition; where there is opposition, conflict follows.

The sharper point is that division is often created in the search for security. The mind says: my religion, my nation, my belief, my group, my knowledge. It divides in order to be safe. But the division produces opposition, and opposition produces insecurity.

Anderson then brings in scriptural language to clarify a related point: doing truth and coming to light are not an if-then sequence. Krishnamurti accepts the direction. Living truth is not an intellectual statement accepted and left static. Action and understanding are not arranged as a bargain in time.

$$\text{Action} \parallel \text{Understanding}. \quad (1.10)$$

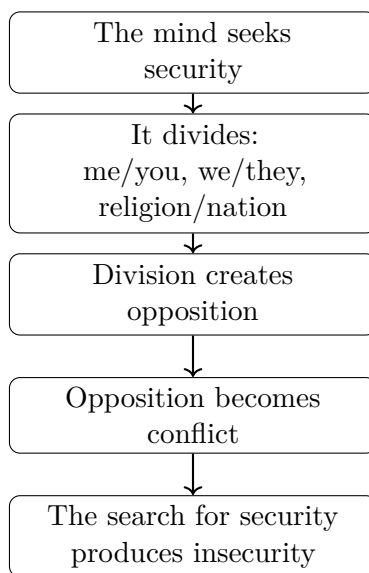


Figure 1.2: The lecture’s movement from security-seeking division to conflict.

The symbol is only shorthand for concurrency. It means that in this part of the dialogue, understanding is not postponed until after action, and action is not the mechanical result of a prior doctrine.

### 1.5.1 Question & Answer

**Question.** Can the conditioned mind, with its millennia of knowledge and division, regenerate now?

**Answer.** This is the hinge of the lecture. Krishnamurti asks whether the human mind, conditioned for millennia and loaded with knowledge in many directions, can change and renew itself now. The phrase “reincarnate now” should be handled cautiously. In this conversation it points to immediate regeneration, not to a doctrine about literal rebirth.

The lecture does not answer by offering a method. It sharpens the problem. If the mind has divided the world in search of security, if that division produces conflict, and if the mind has accumulated knowledge as tradition and image, then we have to ask what place knowledge has in transformation.

## 1.6 Knowledge, Time, and the Past

The lecture now reaches its analytic center. Krishnamurti returns to the word knowledge. Anderson first offers a stricter philosophical meaning: knowledge as apprehension of what is. Krishnamurti instead begins with what is generally accepted as knowledge: experience.

The first chain is simple:

$$\text{Experience} \longrightarrow \text{Mark} \longrightarrow \text{Memory} \longrightarrow \text{Knowledge}. \quad (1.11)$$

Experience leaves a mark. The mark becomes memory. Memory is accumulated as knowledge.

|                         |                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Practical knowledge     | Functional knowledge: how to navigate, build, repair, calculate, speak, remember facts, and operate in the practical order. This has its place. |
| Psychological knowledge | Accumulated image: insult, praise, hurt, flattery, fear, belief, tradition, and remembered injury. This carries the past into relationship.     |

Table 1.2: The lecture preserves practical knowledge while questioning psychological dependence on the known.

The next step is the lecture's central equivalence:

$$\text{Knowledge} = \text{the known}, \quad (1.12)$$

$$\text{the known} = \text{the past}, \quad (1.13)$$

$$\text{Knowledge} = \text{the past}. \quad (1.14)$$

This should be read as conceptual notation, not as a formal identity in a mathematical theory. Krishnamurti's point is that knowledge has its roots in what has been accumulated. It may be used in the present, but it is funded from the past.

This does not abolish practical knowledge. Krishnamurti explicitly says that knowledge has its place. We must know where we are going physically. We need technological, navigational, linguistic, and ordinary functional knowledge. The question is what place knowledge has in changing the quality of a mind that is violent, petty, selfish, greedy, ambitious, and afraid.

### 1.6.1 Question & Answer

**Question.** If knowledge has a place, why ask whether transformation is free from knowledge and time?

**Answer.** Because the issue is not whether the brain can use practical knowledge. The issue is psychological continuity. Knowledge can function in the present, but its roots are in the past. When that past becomes the interpreter of the present, the present is not met directly.

The problem can be written as an update rule:

$$\text{encounter}_{n+1} \longmapsto \text{interpretation}(\text{encounter}_{n+1}; \text{memory}_n). \quad (1.15)$$

The new encounter is translated through the old record. Krishnamurti's point is exact: when the next experience is translated in terms of the old, it is never wholly new.

### 1.6.2 A Worked Conceptual Derivation

The lecture's argument can be kept in a short derivation.

1. An experience occurs.
2. The experience leaves a mark.



3. The mark is retained as memory.
4. Memory is accumulated as knowledge.
5. Knowledge is the known.
6. The known is the past.
7. Therefore psychological knowledge carries the past into the present.
8. If the past interprets the present, the present is not directly met.

In compact notation:

$$E \longrightarrow M, \quad (1.16)$$

$$M \longrightarrow K, \quad (1.17)$$

$$K = P, \quad (1.18)$$

$$P + \text{present encounter} \longrightarrow \text{old interpretation}. \quad (1.19)$$

Here  $E$  denotes experience,  $M$  denotes mark or memory,  $K$  denotes knowledge, and  $P$  denotes the past. The symbols are bookkeeping only. They keep the lecture's sequence visible without pretending that the dialogue has become a formal theory.

## 1.7 Image, Relationship, and Registration

Krishnamurti then makes the analysis concrete. I met you yesterday, and an image of you remains in my mind. Today that image meets you. The image meets you; I do not meet you.

This is the decisive passage from knowledge to relationship. Knowledge is no longer merely information. It has become image. Image is the past carried into contact with another human being.

The lecture gives the equivalence in plain language:

$$\text{Image} = \text{Knowledge} = \text{Tradition} = \text{Past}. \quad (1.20)$$

Again, this is not a formal psychology. It is a compact way to preserve the spoken chain: image is accumulated knowledge, tradition, and past operating in the present.

The question now becomes more difficult. Krishnamurti does not deny that the brain records. He says the brain is recording all the time. The practical problem is whether recording can remain in its necessary place without becoming psychological image.

### 1.7.1 Question & Answer

**Question.** How can the mind record without being trapped by what it records?

**Answer.** The lecture does not give a technique. It refuses the easy answer that one can simply negate the record by will. If you insult me, praise me, flatter me, or hurt me, the event may leave a mark. If that mark becomes image, then the next meeting is governed by memory. The image meets you, and direct relationship is lost.

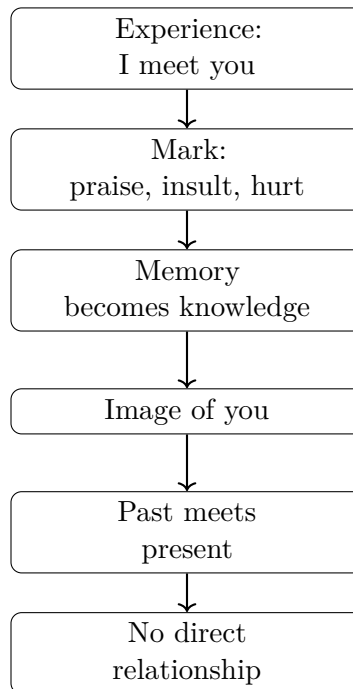


Figure 1.3: A pocket-safe reconstruction of the chain from experience to image and blocked relationship.

The open problem may be written:

$$\text{necessary recording} \not\rightarrow \text{psychological image.} \quad (1.21)$$

This notation marks the question, not the solution. The lecture leaves us with the difficulty: how can the brain record what is needed and not let that record interfere with the present?

Krishnamurti sharpens the point through the word tradition. Tradition hands over the past, but in this context it also betrays the present. Knowledge as tradition becomes the past meeting the present and therefore missing the present.

## 1.8 The Word Is Not the Thing

The last movement turns to theory, religion, description, and action. Religion as it commonly exists is described as tradition, propaganda, belief, idolatry, fear, and division. In that form, it is not the transformation of man. It is another continuation of thought and separation.

Anderson introduces theory in the older sense of seeing or spectacle, but Krishnamurti keeps bringing the inquiry back to direct living. A theory may describe; a belief may console; a word may name. But none of these is the thing itself.

The lecture's final negations are:

$$\text{Word} \neq \text{Thing}, \quad (1.22)$$

$$\text{Description} \neq \text{Described.} \quad (1.23)$$

This is the same structure we saw in the treatment of knowledge and image. The substitute stands between the mind and what is. If one lives in description, one remains in thought, speculation, and repetition. When one is actually confronted with what is, action becomes possible.

**Proposition 1.2.** *In the order of this lecture, transformation is blocked when description, theory, belief, tradition, or image substitutes for direct contact with what is.*

*Proof.* The earlier chain gives the pattern. Experience leaves a mark; the mark becomes memory; memory becomes knowledge; knowledge becomes image; image then meets the present. In the same way, a word, theory, or belief may stand between the human being and the fact. When the mind lives through the substitute, it repeats the past. When it is confronted with what is, the possibility of action appears.  $\square$

The lecture closes by gathering the questions rather than resolving them prematurely. Can there be freedom from knowledge, while knowledge still has its place? Can there be freedom from tradition as knowledge? Can there be freedom from the separative outlook of me and you, we and they, Christian and non-Christian? These are the problems to be attended to as the dialogues continue.

## 1.9 Summary

The conversation begins with the disorder of the world and refuses to treat that disorder as merely external. The human being has made the world, and the world has shaped the human being. Therefore transformation cannot be reduced to social reform, gradual psychological progress, or a theory about change.

The lecture's conceptual spine is:

$$\text{Experience} \longrightarrow \text{Mark} \longrightarrow \text{Memory} \longrightarrow \text{Knowledge} \longrightarrow \text{Image} \longrightarrow \text{blocked relationship.} \quad (1.24)$$

Knowledge has its practical place, but psychological knowledge is the past. When the past meets the present as image, relationship is distorted. When division is taken as security, conflict follows. When description replaces what is, action is postponed.

The chapter therefore ends where the lecture ends: with the question of actual freedom from the known. Not verbal freedom, not speculative freedom, and not the description of freedom, but whether the mind can be free from the old movement of knowledge, image, tradition, and division.